assault began, Indian security personnel took nearly three days to rout just a handful of attackers.[31]

India does enjoy conventional military superiority over Pakistan. This advantage does, not, however, afford the Indians many options for playing the role of regional sorcerer. Their most plausible strategy would be to strike across the line of control against suspected terrorist camps in Pakistani Kashmir.[32] But such attacks, even if successful, would yield only limited benefits because Kashmiri militant camps are transitory in nature and lack high-value human and physical infrastructure.[33]

Because strikes on terrorist camps are not likely to be effective, the Indians might threaten to launch large-scale attacks against Pakistan proper if the Pakistanis fail to prevent further terrorism against India. Although India would eventually prevail, victory in the ensuing conflict would be costly.[34] Nonetheless, such a large-scale confrontation could render continued tolerance for anti-Indian militancy prohibitively expensive for Pakistan, thus finally convincing the Pakistanis to fully renounce the jihadi option. Even if Indian leaders decided that the potential benefits of such a policy were worth the costs, however, it would remain infeasible. The reason is simple: Pakistan's nuclear capacity. Given the danger of nuclear escalation, it would be too risky for the Indians to launch attacks deep into Pakistani territory. In the past, India has been willing to contemplate limited conflict with a nuclear-armed Pakistan. But Pakistan's nuclear capacity has prompted the Indians explicitly to eschew the possibility of launching a full-scale attack on the Pakistanis.[35] This is unlikely to change in the near future.[36]

Neither India's nor Pakistan's intelligence, police, or conventional military forces are able to solve South Asia's sorcerer's apprentice problem. And the countries' nuclear capabilities are largely useless as well. Islamabad's nuclear capacity facilitated its initial adoption of a low-intensity conflict strategy against India during the 1980s and 1990s, preventing large-scale Indian retaliation while Pakistan-backed militants launched attacks in Indian Kashmir. Nuclear weapons cannot now be used to target the militants who flourished as a result of this strategy and currently wreak havoc in both India and Pakistan. Nuclear weapons also limit India's future military